2017

Interview Experiences

SUMMERS 2017

TECHNOLOGY SECTOR

IIM BANGALORE | SIGMA

SIGMA
TECHNOLOGY CLUB
IIM BANGALORE

TABLE OF CONTENTS

MICROSOFT IDC **2**

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN 2

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN 5

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN 7

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN 8

PROCTER & GAMBLE **9**

IT (IOT) MANAGEMENT INTERN 9

HINDUSTAN UNILEVER LIMITED **10**

IT (ENTERPRISE LEVEL SOLUTION HANDLING) 10

VISA **11**

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 11

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 12

AMAZON **14**

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 14

MLDP INTERN 15

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT/MLDP INTERN 16

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN 17

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN 18

SPRINKLR **19**

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 19

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 20

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 21

SAMSUNG R&D **22**

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 22

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 23

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 24

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN 25

TECH STRATEGY INTERN 26

TECH STRATEGY INTERN 27

PRICEWATERHOUSECOOPERS (PWC) **28**

TECH INTERN 28

MICROSOFT IDC

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY NUKALA VIJAYA LAKSHMI

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - 1 GD
    - 1 Interview

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

GROUP DISCUSSION TOPIC

How LinkedIn can be used to in integration with other Microsoft applications to leverage it?

Step 1: The main consumers I am keeping in mind while doing this integration is students and corporate professional who are supposed to do power point presentations and word documents frequently as part of their presentations to the companies or for learning. So here we use Microsoft word document + Linked IN and Power point presentation+ Linked in.

Step 2: Idea

Idea is when a student is working in Word document about a project then according to the key words he types in the document there is a AI search and the results related to the relevant data like power points, documents, and links etc., related to the topic were displayed in a tab, this information is derived from the scholarly data base present in LinkedIn. So that the data base can be used in the LinkedIn to leverage. And Microsoft has a feature called “INSIGHTS” which will summarize the transactions of the data related to bank accounts etc., So here if the professional or student doesn’t have time to skim through all the references that we provide in the references then insight which have a summarized version of the content can be used to refer and get relevant information from that. This insights tab will be provided in the word document

Step 3: Short comes of this process

There is a lot of information in database and user will be overwhelmed with the information provided and gets confused as what to take and up to which extent he should take from the database.

Step 4: How to eliminate this

This can be eliminated by creating options like Student, corporate, Scholarly research etc., so that the relevant information will be provided based on the option we click for. And the quality of the articles will be measured based on the feedback like shares, likes, and comments and ratings given to those articles and they are categorized in to those sections according to its score and the profile of the author of the source article

Step 5: Future updates

If necessary, any videos or conferences related to it can be sent as notifications to the users concerned. So that users can go to the relevant events and gain knowledge from them

INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics

Topic: How will you design a chess game for players

Step 1: First my consumers will be

1) Beginners who have interest in chess and want to learn
2) Players who have a minimum knowledge
3) Tournament players and above

Step 2: In case of allocation of player, we will allocate player based on path dependency for example if a player has won certain games with each game he will be getting some points and based on the points all the players are categorized in to different levels and opposite player will be allocated to a player based on the scores with in those levels. The levels were categorized based on the number of wins for the game, any ratings like Chess federation ratings and some key steps which are used during games which are used by players like Carlson, Anand etc., If the player lost for more than 2 games then the player to him will be allocated a level below to him so that his chances of winning will be high, and he will get back on track with confidence. Here after the game was completed recommended suggestions will be displayed as how Carlson would have played if he was in the players position. How better the player can do the moves and where he can do and analysis for his failure and success.

Step 3: Disadvantages or short comes

Here a player will be allocated other player based on his scores, but back end work will be high during allocation of players. There will be lot many players and the algorithms processing will become difficult to get the right player as pair.

Step 4: To eliminate this

We should divide this based on geographic locations and initially the player should be allocated with players of same geography then with the performance he should be allocated with other geographic players if he is topping in his own geographic regions.

Step 5: Future updates

In future we can add features like notification to the players regarding events in and around the world about the games and information regarding any contest that are held in chess game and videos links of tournament players as recommendations.

Interviewer: what are the key metrics you will use to evaluate the performance of this project

Me:

1) I am assuming this as an app. So, I will consider the number of downloads, number of shares they do this app
2) I will consider the time spent by a player typically using this app
3) I will consider the feedback ad recommendations made about the game
4) I will also consider how effectively people are using to utilize the notifications of events updates we are providing them

Note: I have resume point in Inter University level chess championship. The interviewer saw the resume and asked to design the game

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   None

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**

   Focus on latest technological developments and keep abreast with changes in products.

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY BHARAT KHANNA

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - 1 GD
    - 2 Interviews

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Metrics, Guesstimates

   PRODUCT DESIGNING CASE

   Design a product for smart home using the support of Microsoft Cortana. Also tell why Microsoft can have an edge over Amazon and Google in the same.

   Solution:

   I started by dividing the users of smart home solutions based on age and identified some sample use cases for each division:

   1. Children-> Entertainment, Education

   2. Young adults-> Personal use: Entertainment, Communication, Monitoring Children
   Professional use: Education, Office work

   3. Senior citizens-> Entertainment, Emergency alarm

   I focussed primarily on use case for Young Adults for the professional use as Microsoft is a leader in professional and business applications.

   I proposed a solution where Cortana can be used as a digital assistant to take transcripts of a virtual meeting by converting the voice to text. Designed a wireframe and proposed the metrics for measuring the performance.

   INTERVIEW ROUND 1

   Q1. How does Uber design its pricing strategy? Take a city of the size of Bangalore and estimate.

   For Base pricing, made some guestimates of the market size, the number of drivers and average trip length, costs etc. And came up with a base pricing strategy.

Interviewer further extended the question: How do you determine surge?

I drew the basic Demand Supply curve where

Surge in a locality = Demand in terms of no. of users who are searching for a ride / Supply in terms of no. of drivers ready to accept rides

E.g., if 1000 users are searching and 800 drivers are available, surge would be 1000/800 = 1.25

It was a very basic solution, but the interview was satisfied.

Q2. Suppose you are a Walmart store in a locality and are planning to sell car tyres. How will you determine how many tyres to stock initially?

I proposed that to estimate the market size of tyres in the locality, we could look at the economic division. Interviewer asked me to use data that is available.

So, I proposed that we could count the number of cars in the parking lot of Walmart to estimate rough demand. Interviewer wasn't satisfied. So, I proposed that average value of product in each customers basket can be measured. The customers purchasing higher value of items in each bucket will be the ones most likely owning a car. Based on this data we can estimate the market size.

Interviewer asked me to make a GTM strategy for the same.

I proposed that we could start by advertising in the store by giving free tyre check-ups to customers to build awareness. Discount coupons can be provided within the stores. Referral and social media recommendation can also be used to acquire customers.

INTERVIEW ROUND 2

Puzzle: http://www.geeksforgeeks.org/the-celebrity-problem/

Just asked to write the algorithm

4. What kind of HR questions were asked?

None

5. How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?

Focus on latest technological developments and keep abreast with changes in products.

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY ARUSH DIXIT

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Firstly, there's a case-based GD round on GD day. Based on the GDs, a shortlist is announced and interviews (up to 3 rounds) take place on the next day.
   In GD, there were 6 students and 2 panelists. Each student had to come up with a few ideas and present it individually

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No, you should be a technology enthusiast

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy
   In round 1, they asked to design a recommendation system for product design and monetisation strategy

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   None

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Practice a lot of guesstimates along with some marketing concepts. Go through Cracking the PM book once to get a jest of the same.

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY HARIKA BASAMGARI

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Firstly, there's a case-based GD round on GD day. Based on the GDs, a shortlist is announced and interviews (up to 3 rounds) take place on the next day.
   GD Topic – *Develop features to increase sustainability of Windows in future*
   In GD, there were 6 students and 2 panelists. Each student had to come up with a few **well thought out ideas** and present it to the panelists in the end. The whole process is individual and takes around 40-45 minutes - 35 minutes to think of ideas, and 10-15 minutes to present them.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   If you have a CS background, then the work experience doesn't matter. But if you're from a non-CS background, there should be some relevant work experience.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Behavioral, Guesstimates
   In round 1, they asked to design a recommendation system for a grocery website like Big Basket. In the 2nd round, a guesstimate regarding ad revenues from Bing users in a region was asked. In the 3rd round, apart from the HR questions, they also asked about my B. Tech. Project that was mentioned in the resume.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   - Tell something about yourself.
   - Strengths and Weaknesses
   - Any difficulty you faced in a project and how did you approach the solution?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - Learn how to solve guesstimates
   - Their GDs are focused on product/feature design problems, so prepare very well for these.
   - Learn as much as possible about Microsoft products as GDs and guesstimates are sometimes focused on that.
   - Prepare for HR questions and go through your resume thoroughly.

PROCTER & GAMBLE

IT (IOT) MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY RISHABH OHRI

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   1st round consists of a group interview judging our situational analysis ability followed by 2 more rounds revolving around technical questions and situations one can encounter in a technical field in the office

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, it helps

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Round 1 consisted of Situational Analysis related to P&G culture. 2nd round consisted of technical questions related to the resume while the third round revolved majorly around managerial situations and IoT basics and concepts related to the same.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Tell me about yourself and how do I see myself fit in the P&G culture

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Follow TechGig, Flipboard and keep yourself with the latest technological advancements

HINDUSTAN UNILEVER LIMITED

IT (ENTERPRISE LEVEL SOLUTION HANDLING)

BY SWAPNIL KATIYA

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Firstly, there's a case-based GD round on GD day. Based on the GDs, a shortlist is announced, and interviews take place on the next day. I had to go through 2 rounds of interviews.
   GD Topic – *A caselet provided for rural ERP system and ways to improve it.*
   In my case, the company had already been doing some work for this system which was also mentioned in their PPT. Mentioning that idea also helped a lot as they were looking for candidates who were really interested in the company.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, most of the students shortlisted for interviews had IT work experience.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Round 1 interview lasted for more than an hour. Their major focus was on work experience, where they asked about all the topics mentioned in the resume and went in-depth into one of my projects. Apart from this, I was asked about the impact that recent technologies might have on Enterprise solutions. Lastly, I was asked that why do I want to join HUL IT and not any other company.

   In round 2, they (new interviewers) asked me to tell me about myself and then went back to "Why HUL IT, and not any other company?" They were particularly focused on this question and the discussion in round 2 lasted for almost 25 minutes on this one question only.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   - Tell something about yourself.
   - Why HUL IT, and not any other ProdMan company?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - Attend their PPT and listen to it carefully. They shortlisted from GD based on the ideas from PPT.
   - Prepare well for GD as this was the major criteria for shortlist and only a few students in total were shortlisted.
   - Be very thorough with "Why HUL IT?" question. Any doubt on their part can affect your chances of selection.

VISA

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY KEDAR MAHAMUNI

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - There was no SOP or case submission.
    - There was one GD round. The GD was quite normal. In my GD round, they gave topic on demonetization.
    - There were two rounds of personal interviews, both were technical.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes. The minimum work-ex requirement for application was 42 months.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   PM Topics Covered: Product Design
    - In both the rounds, lots of questions on work experience were asked. As I had 4 years of software engineering experience, they were more interested in knowing what type of challenges I faced, and how did I provide technology based solutions.
    - There were few product design questions as well. Also, they expected end to end technological solutions in detail. Some questions on security algorithms were also asked.
    - Few questions on latest happenings in technology domain were asked

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   No, HR questions were asked to me.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
    - The preparation should involve practice of product design questions.
    - As most of the questions are from previous job, so proper understanding about things written in CV is essential.
    - Subscribe to newsletters provided by TechCrunch, Wired, Inc42 and the like where you will know the latest technologies and their applications in various firms around the world.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP2s:**
   Not just about VISA, but for other tech companies also, practice guesstimates and product design questions.

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY MINARVA MALIK

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc).**
   a. There was no SOP or case submission.
      First selection Criteria:**42 months of relevant (Technical) work experience.**
      (But relevant work ex was relaxed after GD)
   b. There was one GD round. The GD was quite normal. My GD the topic was on **Demonetization: Success or failure**. There were looking for the candidates who were bringing new substantial points to the discussion.
   c. There were two rounds of personal interviews, both were technical.
      But prior Knowledge about industry and company was a bonus. They asked me whether I have any questions for them. I asked two questions one regarding industry and one about innovation. They were impressed by my interest in the company.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes. The minimum work-ex requirement for application was 42 months.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Design
   a. In both the rounds, lots of questions on work experience were asked. As I had 5 years of experience in Infosys software developer. I was developing software for Mortgage domain of a bank. So, they asked me about mortgage basic flow and US subprime mortgage crisis.
   b. There were few product design questions as well. Also, they expected end to end technological solutions in detail.
   c. Few questions on latest happenings in technology domain were asked (ALEXA Vs Google Home)

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   a. Why Payments solutions
   b. Why VISA

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   a. The preparation should involve practice of product design questions.
   b. As most of the questions are from previous job, so proper understanding about things written in CV is essential.

c. Subscribe to newsletters provided by TechCrunch, Wired, Inc42 and the like where you will know the latest technologies and their applications in various firms around the world.

6. Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:

a. Not just about VISA, but for other tech companies also, practice guesstimates and product design questions.

AMAZON

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY SHUBHAM RAJ

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   There's no GD for Amazon. Students are directly shortlisted for interviews based on resume. Only one round of interview (~50 minutes) was conducted.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No, it doesn't matter. I didn't have any IT-related work experience.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy

   There was only 1 round of interview which was started with the question "What is Product Management?". After that I was asked why did I want to join Amazon.

   The rest of the interview was based on the next question – "Mention any 3 services which are not provided by Amazon.". One of the services mentioned by me was selling cars via Amazon. After this they discussed the following questions with me –

   - How can Amazon enter in this service?
   - What is the benefit for Amazon to enter this service?
   - How will the dealers react for their lost sales and how will you interact with them?
   - There was in-depth discussion on Logistics too.
   - How will you convince Maruti to sell via Amazon?
   - What features should be provided for Amazon app for cars?

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   - Why do you want to join Amazon?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - Learn 14 principles of Amazon thoroughly and during answering try to put some elements in your answers.
   - You should know the products and services provided by Amazon thoroughly.

BY NIKITA NALLAMOTHU

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Resume Shortlist and 2 rounds of interview

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, they were looking for people with work experience.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Design
   In the first round of interview I was about my work experience. They focused on situations where I showed my leadership skills and resolved business issues. I was also asked about how my learnings from my work experience can be implemented at Amazon. The second interview was a product design question asked in product management interviews. I was asked to design a system for the government for waste management in a metropolitan city.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   The first interview was a kind of HR round. I was asked only about work experience.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Be up-to-date with all the recent happenings in the tech world particularly ecommerce sector. Prepare guestimates, it will be useful for any interview. For PM roles definitely read the book “Cracking the PM Interview” by McDowell and Bavaro. Important to have interest in technology and it should come out through your interview.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP2s:**

   Pick up products and think about how you can improve them. Think from customer’s point of view. Be aware of the recent happenings in e commerce.

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT/MLDP INTERN

BY SUCHETH P

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Role: Not sure whether MLDP or product management. Although the interview was based on product development questions.
   Number of interview rounds: 2
   GD: No

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, a bit.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Root Cause Analysis, Product Design, Product Strategy
   FIRST ROUND

   The interview was a short one with only one interviewer. He gave me a case question stating, "The sales of Trousers are declining continuously, find out the reason". After this he asked me if there is any new feature that I can suggest for Amazon's website.

   SECOND ROUND

   The interview started with my past work responsibilities. As I have worked for an automobile company, they told me to design a mobile app for showcasing important features of car. They told me focus on user interface and the important features (like car's fuel level, engine oil level etc.). The discussion continued to ways of earning revenues from the applications and key performance indicators. Also, some questions revolved around how the data retrieved from each user be useful for business purposes. The discussion went for around 30 minutes.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Any ethical dilemma faced in work environment? How did you handle any conflicts you faced with your supervisor?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   While answering always follow a structured way. The deeper you drill down any questions, the better it is. I had a very healthy discussion in the case interview. The interviewers were helping a lot in between. Go through Amazon's 14 principles.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:** Be calm and confident in the interview. Try questioning the interviewer to gain more information during case solving, don't just give answers based your assumptions.

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY RAUSHAN SINHA

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc).**
   No GD, Only one round of interview

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Minimum 22 months
   Only for category management profile, freshers were allowed.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Behavioral
   1. Real life cased based question: During Cauvery dispute, there were issues related to inter border transfer of goods from Karnataka to TN and vice-versa, being a head of logistics department how will you ensure the ease of flow of goods from one state to another?? Short term and long-term measures?
   2. What do you understand by operations and supply chain management and what according to you are the scopes for operations and SCM at Amazon?

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   1. Tell me something about yourself?
   2. Tell me the most commendable thing you have done in your career so far?
   3. What improvements or changes did you bring to the existing procedures and systems at your previous company and how has the company benefited from it?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   1. Know your resume. Be thorough with all the points and prepare credible stories supporting each point.
   2. Focus on basics of operations management course taught in Term 2.
   3. Case based preparation would help in structuring the thought process.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   If in case you are eyeing for an operations or S&M job role, focus on GDs and guestimate problems.

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY HIMANSHU MITTAL

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Resume Shortlist and 1 round of interview

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Not actually. They are looking for a cultural fit.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy
   They try to judge if you are customer focused. They asked me "Tell me about yourself". They asked me more about my business and how I launched a product. They asked me about the challenges I faces while launching it. They also asked me about a situation where I showed leadership skills. They also asked me how I handled situations of conflict. They also asked me if I knew SQL.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   I had only one interview and I was asked only HR questions as mentioned above. No technical questions were asked.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Be thorough with your resume points and your learnings from those points.
   Read Amazon's leadership principles and try to relate your learning to those principles.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP2s:**
   Solve cases and guestimates with basic frameworks. Be open while answering, engage in a two-way conversation with the interviewer.

SPRINKLR

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY ANKUR AGARWAL

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   - GD
   - Interview – 2 rounds

   GD Topic: NCERT is launching a web/app based Edu portal. Design an MVP (Minimum Viable Product) for the same.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   I felt so. Being from non-CS background but working in IT sector helped me. A lot of questions were asked on my work ex.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Root Cause Analysis, Guesstimates

   FIRST ROUND
   1. Tell me about yourself.
   2. Questions on Work Experience (Web App development and Data Quality domain)
   3. How will you implement technology in toll plazas on highways?
   4. (Follow-up on 3) What are the proposed technology benefits to users? To business? To government?
   5. Why are you interested in Product Management?
   6. (Case study) Swiggy is seeing a decrease in number of orders. Analyse.
   7. Any questions for us.

   SECOND ROUND
   1. Questions on work experience.
   2. (Guesstimate) Analyse the economic cost of traffic jam at Sarjapur Road, Bangalore (Road on which Wipro HQ is located).
   3. What are the biggest tech trends you are seeing these days? Please don't keep saying social media.
   4. Any questions for us.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   None.

5. **How do you recommend someone to structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Practice guesstimates. An idea on how cases are solved especially MECE will help you structure your thoughts in a case. Prepare your resume well. They are interested in what all you have done till now. Read the "Cracking the PM Interview" book. It is a one-stop solution for all Metric, PM, SOP, and HR questions. For system design questions, check out blog at gainlo.co (not .com).

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY SANATH UPADHYA

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - GD
    - Interview – 2 rounds

2. **GD topic**

   Future of e-payments in India

3. **Does work experience matter?**

   Yes. Most of the questions in the interview was based on my prior work experience.

4. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Guesstimates

FIRST ROUND

1. Tell me about yourself.
2. Some questions related to my work experience (cloud computing)
3. One guesstimate (number of planes taking off from Bengaluru)
4. Difference between Product Management and Program Management.
5. Why are you interested in Product Management?
6. As a product manager, if you have an option to implement a feature or improve on an existing one, which option would you choose and why? (I went for improving on an existing feature as I felt retention of customers was more important than adding new customers)

SECOND ROUND

1. Questions related to my work experience
2. What do you know about the company?

5. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**

   None.

6. **How do you recommend someone to structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**

   Have a general idea of the roles and responsibilities of a product manager.

   Practice guesstimates.

   Ensure that you have a story for all the points on your resume. Most of my interview was spent on the points that I'd written in my resume.

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY MOLISHVINAYAGAN

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - Group discussion
    - Technical interview
    - HR interview

2. **GD topic**
   Design a product that offers 24*7 medical support in village.

3. **Does work experience matter?**
   No.

4. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Work experience related, Product design question, Guestimates

5. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   What are your long-term goals? Why product management?

SAMSUNG R&D

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY HAARIKA KANTE

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   GD on GD day, followed by one round of interview.
   GD Topic – *Is India ready for smart homes?*

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Not sure about this.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Metrics, Guesstimates
   In the interview, they first explained the role and responsibilities. After that, a DS based guesstimate was asked in which they wanted to know what all data to collect and how if we want to analyse vehicles passing through a few signals during peak hours. The focus in this question was on the various approaches to collect samples, and their distribution. A few resume-based questions were also asked.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   - Give one example each for - when you worked as a team, and when you facilitated cross-team interaction

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Prepare for Guesstimates and be thorough with basics of DS1. Go through your resumes well and prepare for HR questions.

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY SHUBHANSHUK SARKAR

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - 1 GD: What features will you add in your dream product?
    - 1 Interview: 20 mins, 5-6 questions

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, a bit.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Resume based, asked about user retention in mobile games

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   How do you influence programming leads, design leads without authority?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   I attended only 1 Prod Man FOCAL GD. Prep your work ex very well. Resume points should be backed up.

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY ANIKET WANI

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Resume Shortlist, GD and 1 round of interview

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No, I was not asked any questions about my work experience.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Metrics, Guesstimates
   I was asked questions from my resume. I was also asked a guestimate question. I was also asked questions on metrics. I was also asked about the products and apps of Samsung. It is important to know what are their recent updates and area of focus. Also, I was asked about my views on recent burning issues in Samsung.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Questions were related to how I can make an impact in the company during 2 months of internship.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Subscribe to newsletters provided by TechCrunch, Wired, Inc42 and the like where you will know the latest technologies and their applications in various firms around the world. Do guestimates. Be thorough with your resume.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP2s:**
   Attend GDs by Focal. Be calm and cool during the interview and GD process.

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT INTERN

BY NIKHIL KUMAR

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    1. Resume Submission
    2. GD
    3. Tech Interview
    4. HR Round

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Not Sure. (May be No)

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Metrics
    - Have you ever dealt with huge data and what you did with that?
    - What all will you consider while designing a washing machine?
    - Explain your previous job at Samsung?
    - Random coding algorithm (sorting, searching etc.)
    - What extra will you bring after MBA as compared to Non-MBA PM.
    - Xiaomi v/s Samsung Question in India.
    - How to increase number of users for S Health App? How will you measure success of your suggestion?

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
    - Question related to Samsung work culture? Is it good or bad? How will you improve it?
    - What does a Product Manager do?
    - Why you left Samsung although you got 3 promotions in 4 years and again want to join Samsung?
    - Tell me about yourself?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/tools that can help aid in preparation?**
    - Go through the resume points thoroughly especially if you have work experience.
    - Practice a lot of Product design question (How will you design any product?)
    - Study about latest tech news?
    - Understand the role of PM very well before interview.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP2s:** Know every point from your resume very well.

TECH STRATEGY INTERN

BY UJJWAL SEN

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - 1 GD: Future of payment platforms in India
    - 1 Interview: 40 mins, 7-8 questions

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: App Critique
   Resume based: How did you develop your PoC in your Internship? How did you deliver on the version1 project? What challenges did you face? How did you like that experience?
   What is your favourite app in your phone? How will you improve it? Which start-up acquired/ invested in by Samsung Ventures do you like? Who are the customers and how do you think will customer acquisition happen?

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   How will you identify a good start-up? What will you look for?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Attended 2 Prod Man FOCAL GDs. Prep your work ex very well. Resume points should be backed up. **Do not globe**.

TECH STRATEGY INTERN

BY UDIT KUMAR

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - 1 GD: Future of Smart wearables
    - 1 Interview: 20-25 mins, 6-7 questions
    - 1 HR round 1-2 questions

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Metrics, Guesstimates
   From work ex. Google analytics, designed the GoIbibo hotels page – how does Google analytics help? What data were you tracking for conversion rate? 1 guestimate: Market size of google glass in India?

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   How comfortable are you with your role? What are the exit options?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Mock interview (PGP 3) by Sigma was helpful, Tech background, guestimates, resume points and work ex should be prepared

PRICEWATERHOUSECOOPERS (PwC)

TECH INTERN

BY KATHIRVEL T

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
    - 1 Interview: 15 mins,
    - 1 question guestimate: 5-6 questions

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   1 guestimate: How much cable would you need in Bengaluru?

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   How do you influence programming leads, design leads without authority?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   IIM B casebook helped, Interest in tech, Resume points should be backed up.